S. No.	World's Fishing banks	Confluence of ocean currents
1.	The Grand bank (Atlantic Ocean, New foundland)	Gulf Stream and Labrador current
2.	The Agulhas bank (Atlantic Ocean, South west Africa)	Benguela cold current and Agulhas warm current
3.	The Dogger bank (Atlantic Ocean, North east of N.A)	North Atlantic drift and canary cold current
4.	The Reed bank (South China Sea, Pacific Ocean)	Kuroshio Warm current and Oyashio Cold Current
5.	The Pedro bank (India Ocean)	South Equatorial warm current and W. Australian cold current

The significance of Ocean Currents

1. Ocean currents play an important role in the earth's climate. They distribute energy and nutrients within the ocean.
2. Fog is formed where warm current and cold current meet. For example, when the Gulf Stream and Labrador Current meet near New Found land one of the densest fogs is formed.
3. The warm ocean current increases the temperature of an area where it flows to and Cold Ocean current decreases the temperature of the area.
4. The warm current brings heavy rainfall when the wind blows over it becomes warm while the cold current brings drought when the wind blows over it becomes cold and dry. For example, the wind blowing over the Peru Current is cold and dry causing the formation of the Atacama Desert located on the west coast of Peru.
5. It regulates the global temperature. It gives free navigation. The Gulf Stream keeps ports & harbours of Russia and Scandinavia navigable throughout the year. The Kuroshio Current makes ports on Japan navigable during winter.
6. It distributes minerals and pollution added to it becomes highly diluted and later negligible.
7. It helps in growth of juveniles of certain fish and its distribution to other countries - from its place of origin. Some up welling and down welling are due to currents which bring minerals to photic zone used by phytoplankton. Major fishing grounds are located in the zones where cold current and warm current meet.

El Nino

El Nino is a phenomenon that occurs in the equatorial Pacific Ocean characterized by a positive sea surface temperature departure from normal (1971-2000 base period) in the region lying within the latitude 5°N to 5°S and longitudes 120° W to 170°W . This phenomenon occurs every two to seven years (Figure 5.19).

El Nino happens when

- Sea surface temperature increases between the central and eastern equatorial Pacific Ocean between the country Ecuador and the International Date Line

TN_Govt_Geography_XI_Std Unit_05.indd 130 2/3/2020 4:25:06 PM